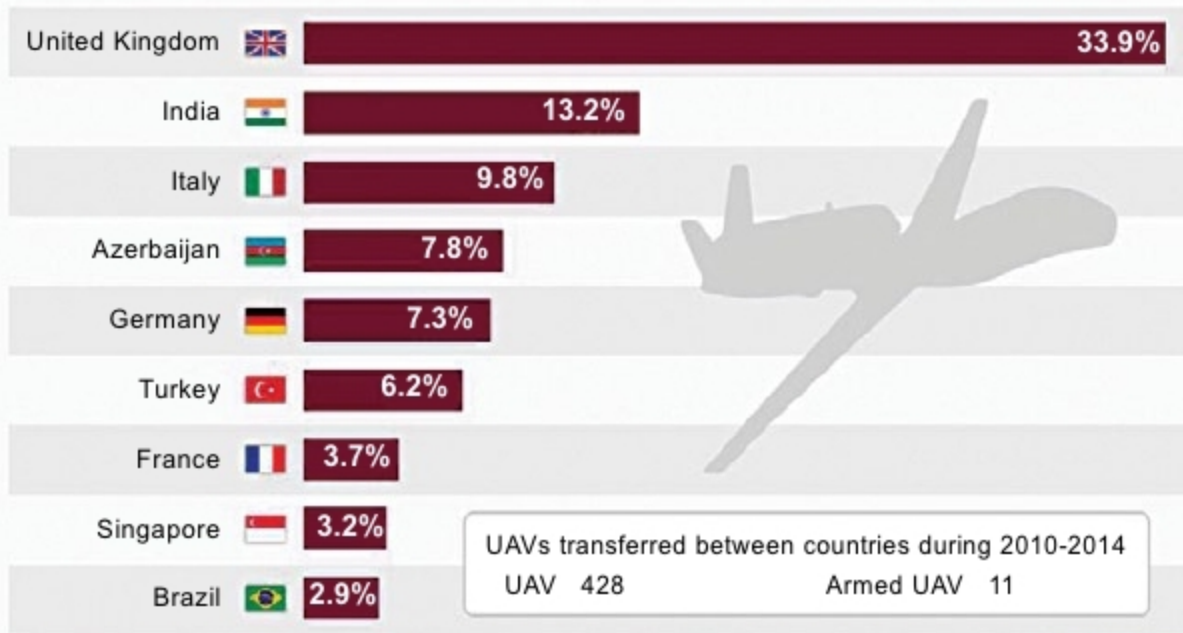


Countries Importing The Most Drones

% of UAVs imported by countries from 2010 to 2014



Top importers of drones in the world (Credit: www.statista.com)

legally use drone technology must obtain necessary permits for drone usage from the government. However, to open doors for innovation, the government has specified that using nano-drones (UAVs that weigh up to 250gms) and those operated by government agencies do not require any permit.

As per a study by Allied Market Research, aerial photography via drones is estimated to reach US\$ 2.8 million mark worldwide by 2022. For instance, Mumbai-based drone startup Airpix specialises in using drones for aerial mapping of areas that are otherwise difficult to reach. Shinil Shekhar, co-founder - Airpix, says, "We provide data acquisition and analysis solutions using UAVs for multiple industries. The solutions and reports provided by us help

clients in project designing, progress monitoring, volume calculations and inspection of critical assets."

Shekhar adds, "Drones are just a platform. What you make of them depends on how you select the sensors based on your project requirement and what kind of insights you derive after processing that data."

While globally, industrial use of drones for mapping is done extensively, India is still at a nascent stage. Industry players hold the current regulations responsible for the slow growth in this category. "For drones to become a great business, healthy regulations have to be in place—regulations that will promote the technology, safeguard national security and ensure public safety," notes Shekhar.

—Nidhi Arora, executive editor, EFY

What's The IoT Got To Do With *Chai*?

► By blending the IoT with flavours, tea joints in India are turning cups of tea into smart tea

What if you are greeted by a long queue at the counter when you visit a tea joint for a steaming cup of *chai*? Having to wait is not great on a hectic day. Now, imagine a robot replacing the manual *chai*-making process—reading your typical preferences and offering you a cup of your favourite flavour in no time. Or, a machine filling up a cup of tea for you with fresh milk, instead of pre-mixed beverages available in your office? These are some of the things tea joints in India are doing to give their tea-loving customers a splendid experience that goes beyond *chai*.

The Internet of Things (IoT) is omnipresent now—its even in your cup of tea. Let us grab a steaming cup and know about the wonders of the IoT on *chai*.

This *chai* brewer can read your mind

Arya is an IoT-enabled smart device that works with multiple cloud

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